Task Kinds

Four kinds of tasks are called experience tasks, shared tasks,guided tasks, and independent tasks.

Rippen's Approach

Reppen discusses the genre-based approach, which in recent years has received a lot of attention from researchers as well as practitioners. A genre-based approach provides students with ample opportunities to become aware of the different purposes of written communication and the different ways information is organized in written texts. Unless students are exposed to these different text types and are given sufficient practice in these types of writing, their written products will leave much to be desired. In his paper

Five stages of Seow in the process approach to teaching writing

Planning, drafting, revising, and editing, responding, evaluating and post writing

Close Test

Every fifth word has been taken out of a reading passage that the learners have never seen before. The learners must fill in the missing words by guessing. They look at the words before and after the empty space to help them guess the missing words. The test measures how close the reader's thought is to the writer's thought.

Vocabulary Test and Teacher

The teacher should sit next to the learner while the test is being done to make sure that the learner takes the test seriously, follows a sensible test-taking strategy, knows how to handle the slightly unusual test format, and is not experiencing reading problems which might interfere with the sitting of the test. It is very important that the teacher does this because it has happened that a whole class of learners sitting a test have not taken it seriously and have got low marks. In this case, the teacher then set up a programme to teach the

vocabulary which the learners actually already knew.

Speed Reading Graphs

When learners do a regular speed reading course they keep a graph of their speed and a graph of their comprehension, and for each passage they read, the results are entered on the graphs. This can be highly motivating for learners, particularly if their speed can be seen to increase and their comprehension remains steady. Similar graphs for comprehension are used with the SRA reading boxes. These graphs can be even more motivating if a goal is set. For speed reading this could be a goal of around 300 words per minute.

Reading Logs

A log is a regular record of work done. When learners do extensive reading, they can keep a log noting the title, level, degree of enjoyment, and time taken to read for each graded reader or other book they read. Bamford and Day (2004) have several suggestions about the form of these logs.

Dicto-comp

When doing a **reproduction exercise** the learners read or listen to a story and then they retell it without looking at the original. This type of composition is easier if the learners are allowed to read or listen to the story several times, before they write it. The teacher can tell the learners to try to write the story so that it is very similar to the original, or to add extra details and make changes if they wish. The same technique can be used with spoken instead of written input. The teacher reads a story to the class. After they have listened to the story, they must write it from their memory. If the teacher wants to give the learners a lot of help, the teacher reads the story several times, but not so many times that the learners can copy it exactly. As the learners cannot remember all the words of the story, they have to make up parts of it themselves. This gives them practice in composition. This exercise is sometimes called a **dicto-comp**

Experienced and Independent task

The difference between an experience and independent task lies in the control and preparation that goes into an experience task. Experience tasks are planned so that learners are faced with

only one aspect of the task that is outside their previous experience. Independent tasks do not involve this degree of control and learners may be faced with several kinds of difficulty in the same task.

The Purpose of Reinforcement Writing

Reinforcement writing has always been used as a means of reinforcing language that has, been taught. In its simplest form, teachers often ask students to write sentences using recently learnt grammar. Suppose, for example, that intermediate students have recently been practicing the third conditional (If + had (not) done + would (not) have done), they might be given the following instruction: Write two sentences about things you wish had turned out differently, and two sentences about things you are pleased about.

Activity Writing

Writing can also, of course, be used as an integral part of a larger activity where the focus is on something else such as language practice, acting out, or speaking. Teachers often ask students to write short dialogues which they will then act out. The dialogues are often most useful if planned to practice particular functional areas, such as inviting or suggesting.

English as a Second Language (ESL) - this term is normally used to describe students who are living in the target language community and who need English to function in that community on a day-to-day basis, Recent immigrants and refugees, for example, will have specific writing needs such as the ability to fill in a range of forms, or write particular kinds of letters (depending upon their exact needs and circumstances), alongside the need for general English development.

English for Specific Purposes (ESP) - many students study English for a particular (or specific) purpose. People who are going to work as nurses in Britain or the USA, for example, will study medical English. Those who are going to study at an English-medium university need to concentrate on English for Academic Purposes (EAP). Business students will concentrate on the language of management and commerce, and so on,

Creative Writing

Creative writing is one area (like painting and composing) where the imagination has a chance to run free. The world is full of people who achieve great personal satisfaction in this way. In their book Process Writing, the authors Ron White and Valerie Arndt describe an approach that 'views all writing — even the most mundane and routine ~ as creative'. Such an approach would even include, at some level, the putting together of a shopping list, But we are concerned here with tasks that provoke students to go beyond the everyday, and which ask them to spread their linguistic wings, take some chances, and use the language they are learning to express more personal or more complex thoughts and images.

Writing Subprocess

- They do not necessarily occur in a certain order. For some writers, organizing ideas may occur after they have been written. For many writers there is movement from one stage to another in a continuous cycle.
- The effects of these subprocesses can be seen in learners' writing and in their spoken comments while and after they write. Several studies (Raimes, 1985; Zamel, 1983; Arndt, 1987) have observed and analysed the performance of second language teachers' writing and have described typical behaviour of experienced and inexperienced writers in relation to the parts of the process.

Types of Writing

- a note or formal letter
- a formal letter
- résumé, summary, paraphrase
- narrative
- description
- exposition, analysis, definition, classification
- narrative, description, with evaluative comment
- argument
- literary
- advertisement, media
- journal writing

Cubing

Cubing is when the learners consider the topic from six angles: (1) describe it; (2) compare it; (3) associate it; (4) analyze it; (5) apply it; (6) argue for and against it. They note the ideas that each of these points of view suggest and decide which ones they will use in their writing. Other similar procedures include asking, "who, what, when, where, how, why".

Different Spellings Systems in Putting Your Ideas into Text from L1 To L2

A possible cause is the difference between the writing systems of the learners' first language and the second language. Arab learners of English have greater difficulty in this part of the writing process than Indonesian or French learners do because of the different written script. If the learners' first language uses a different writing system from English, then there is value in practising the formal skills of forming letters of the alphabet and linking these letters together. There is also value in giving some attention to spelling.

Benefits of Reviewing

This is done to check what ideas have already been included in the writing, to keep the coherence and flow of the writing, to stimulate further ideas, and to look for errors. Poor writers do not review, or review only to look for errors.

Genres and Register

Just as the advertisement was typical of its kind for the same reasons. We call these different writing constructions advertisements', 'letters', etc.) genres, and we refer to the specific choice of vocabulary within genere as the register that the text is written in.

Paragraph into a Sequence

But then the phone rang, and it was friend Sarah asking if he wanted to go and see a movie. He agreed immediately, and was out of the door in almost no time at all. He didn't have any ideas. Paul was sitting at home, wondering 'what to do.

Proper Sequence:

Paul was sitting at home, wondering what to do. He didn't have any ideas. But then the phone rang, and it was his friend Sarah asking if he wanted to go and see a movie, He agreed immediately, and was out of the door in almost no time at all.

Engaging Writing

An **engaging** writing task is one that involves students not just intellectually but emotionally as well; it amuses them, intrigues them, or makes them feel good. When students are 'switched on' by engaging tasks there is a good chance that some of their doubts about writing will disappear.

Instant Writing

There are stages in any lesson where students can be asked to write on the spot, without much in the way of preparation or warning; this is **instant writing**.

Because instant writing is not part of a long writing process, it can be used whenever the teacher feels it is appropriate. The tasks may each take only ten or fifteen minutes or be even shorter; but a regular diet of such tasks will boost students' confidence, if they are appropriate, since each time

they will have something worthwhile and interesting to show for their efforts.

Difference between Immigrants and International Students

We make a distinction between immigrant and international students in this discussion because immigrant students (some of whom may be the children of immigrants or immigrants themselves) may have permanent resident status. Meanwhile, international students usually enter English-speaking countries on student visas, complete their college or university studies, and subsequently return to their home countries.
Further distinctions are to be made between students taking courses in intensive English programs (lEPs) and their counterparts in traditional degree programs.

Different between Traditional and Non-Traditional Students

Traditional students (both NS and NNS) are sometimes described as such if they have experienced few if
any interruptions in their progress from secondary school to (and through) postsecondary education. That is, traditional students are those who upon completion of secondary school proceed directly to a community college, four-year college, or research university, and from there, perhaps to a graduate or professional Program. Because of this rapid progress from a secondary to a postsecondary institution, traditional students usually are young adults in their late teens or early twenties when they begin their Postsecondary education. Nontraditional or "returning" students, on the other hand, may have experienced one or more interruptions along their educational pathways. These interruptions can include substantial periods of full-time employment (and sometimes the pursuit of a new career), as well as considerable time devoted to caring for children, elderly family members, or both. These students, whose numbers are increasing rapidly in many educational institutions, thus represent a variety of age groups (Peterson, 1995; Stewart, 1993). Moreover, many nontraditional students reinitiate their formal studies while working and may likewise have personal, financial, and family commitments to fulfill.

All Writing is Ideological

Articles by Santos (1992), McKay (1993), Severino (1993), and Benesch (1993) have discussed the role of ideology in teaching writing. Terry Santos tells us that ESL composition "see[s] itself pragmatically" and so "avoid[s] ideology" (1992, p. 80). And some teachers insist that their teaching is not associated with ideology in any way. Those in my graduate course have said emphatically, "In my classroom I teach English and there's no ideology in that." But Sarah Benesch points out that "all forms of ESL instruction are ideological, whether or not educators are conscious of the political implications of their instructional choices" (1993, p. 705). She illustrates this with an analysis of English for academic purposes (EAP). She points out that in its attempts "to adapt students to the status quo" (p. 714) by presenting the demands of literacy as "positive artifacts of a normative academic culture" (p. 710), EAP turns toward "an accommodationist ideology" (p. 714), which prepares students to be assimilated into systems that instructors never question and that their students never examine critically. She claims, then, that all writing is ideological.

Structural Course Design

Structural. Writing courses, particularly at beginning levels, can be organized around grammar and sentence patterns. A present tense paragraph one day, then a past tense paragraph, and so on. This was common in the 1960s, but is less so now. Structural courses nowadays are often organized by patterns of writing forms or genres: paragraphs with topic sentences, descriptions, analyses, and so on.

GROUP BRAINSTORMING

GROUP BRAINSTORMING

Group members spew out ideas about the topic. Spontaneity is important here. There are no right or wrong answers. Students may cover familiar ground first and then move off to more abstract or wild territories.

Clustering

CLUSTERING

Students form words related to a stimulus supplied by the teacher. The words are circled and then linked by lines to show discernible clusters. Clustering is a simple yet powerful strategy: "Its visual character seems to stimulate the flow of association . . . and is particularly good for students who know what they want to say but just can't say it" (Proett & Gill, 1986, p. 6).

Principles for your Editing Approach

- Students and teachers should focus on major patterns of error rather than attempt to correct every single error (Bates, Lane, & Lange, 1993).
- Because not all students will make the same errors, it is necessary and desirable to personalize editing instruction as much as possible.
- The errors to focus on should be those that are most frequent, global (interfere with the comprehensibility of the text), and stigmatizing (would cause a negative evaluation from native speakers) (Bates, Lane, & Lange, 1993; Hendrickson, 1980).

Grammatical Errors

I need to buy some book

I gained a lot of knowledges in high school.

That TV show come on at 8:00.

My father is very generosity.

He likes mathematics in school.

I need to buy book.

Process-Oriented Writing Pedagogies

Process-oriented writing pedagogies focused particular attention on procedures for solving problems, discovering ideas, expressing them in writing, and revising emergent texts—typically, in isolation from any cultural, educational, or sociopolitical contexts in which writing might take place (Canagarajah, 2002; Casanave, 2003; Hyland, 2003). Faigley (1986) divided process writing proponents into two distinct categories: expressivists and cognitivists. Expressivists (Elbow, 1973,1981a, 1981b; Macrorie, 1984; Murray, 1985; Zamel, 1982, 1983) viewed composing as "a creative act in which the process—the discovery of the true self—is as important as the product" (Berlin, 1988, p. 484).

Cognitivist Approaches to Teaching

Hallmarks of cognitivist approaches to teaching L1 and L2 writing as a process include invention and prewriting tasks, drafting of multiple versions of writing assignments, abundant text level revision, collaborative writing, feedback sessions, and the postponement of editing until the final stages of the composing cycle

Publication

Another form of positive feedback is publication. This can take many forms. Reading written work aloud to others is a form of publication. Having your work circulated or posted on the wall of the classroom is another, and having it appear in a printed collection is yet another.

Sources of Feedback for a Written Work

The feedback can come from the teacher, from peers, and from the learners themselves in self-assessment. The use of peer feedback can reduce the teacher's load but is also very valuable in helping writers develop a sense of audience. The use of self-assessment encourages metacognitive awareness of the writing process and the qualities of good writing.

Benefits of Conferencing on a Portfolio

Conferencing on a portfolio allows the opportunity to look at weaknesses and strengths which appear in several pieces of writing and thus deserve comment. It also allows the opportunity to see improvement
across several pieces of writing. This improvement can be in the quantity written, the quality of the writing, and quality and range of the content. Conferencing is also used at different stages of a piece of writing so that
the learner is helped to improve a particular piece of writing. Conferencing takes a lot of time but its focused one-to-one interaction brings many benefits.
Lesson 40

Reformulation

Reformulation involves a native speaker rewriting a learner's piece of writing so that the learner can then compare their first attempt with the reformulation. This is a very time-consuming process which places a heavy burden on the native speaker. However, those who support this procedure speak very highly of it.

Between Analytic and Holistic Marking

Analytic marking has also been used as a way of increasing the points of assessment. Analytic marking involves having a marking scheme that awards marks for things like richness and appropriateness of vocabulary use, grammatical accuracy, organisation, and overall communicative effectiveness. For each of these categories, marks from 0 to 5 can be awarded. The marks for all the categories can be added up to get a final grade. This contrasts with holistic marking where the marker reads the piece of writing and awards an overall grade for it. In analytic marking each point on each of the categories is arguably a point of assessment. The debate regarding holistic and analytic marking continues.

Benefits of Writing Conferences for Teachers

One concerns the perception that writing conferences save teachers time and energy that would otherwise be spent marking student papers. Another is the immediacy and potential for interaction and negotiation that the conferencing event offers, allowing for on-the-spot clarification of difficult issues (Conrad & Goldstein, 1999) and helping teachers to avoid appropriating student texts (Brannon & Knoblauch, 1982; Sommers, 1982; Zamel, 1985). Finally, with the consideration given in recent years to students' learning styles (Reid, 1995b; see chapter 1), it is argued that writing conferences offer a more effective means for communicating with students who are auditory rather than visual learners. Some writing instructors feel so strongly about the value of writing conferences that they have suggested doing away with all other forms of in-class instruction to make time for them (Carnicelli, 1980; Garrison, 1974).

Writing Conference

The writing conference is a one-on-one strategy that takes place between the student writer and the teacher. Conferring is perhaps the best opportunity for direct and immediate teaching of the complex processes and skills involved in writing. Individual conferences generally are short, about two to five minutes, and occur while the other students are involved in their own independent writing projects.

Syntactic and Lexical Errors among Native and Nonnative Students

When thinking about the importance of accuracy in the academic writing of NNS students, many ESL and EAP teachers believe that syntactic and lexical errors in L2 texts are not particularly damaging because NS writers also make numerous mistakes in their texts. However, several studies have found that faculty in the disciplines have a far more critical view of ESL errors than those of NSs (Santos, 1988; Vann et al., 1984, 1991). Although the indications of error gravity vary across disciplines and even vary according to the age of faculty, the conclusions in all investigations largely remain similar: ESL errors in students' texts are costly in terms of grades and overall evaluations of work quality.

ESP

ESP: English for Special Purposes includes students who are learning English in context of a certain field, profession, or topic. For example, when I was teaching legal English in China, I

was teaching English in context of law. These students were learning English in preparation for studying law through an American university where the professors were all native English speakers.

Cause and Effect Interpretation Tasks

Cause-effect interpretation tasks deal with establishing causal relationships and are based on causal reasoning. Most assignments of this type include a discussion or an explanation of a cause-effect relationship among events or problems, identification of causes or effects, and a presentation of problem solutions in the case of problem-solution tasks.
Examples of cause-effect interpretation assignments can be:
1. *Pabst Blue Ribbon was a major beer company when I was in college. However, recently it has lost market share, and now you hardly even hear about it. What happened at Pabst and why?* (Business) (Adapted from Bean, 1996)
2. *Why does culture arise in the first place? Why is culture a necessary part of all organized life?* (Sociology) (Charon, 1999, p. 105)
TLFeBOOK

Analysis Assignments

Analysis of information or facts (in medium-length assignments) requires writers to separate a whole into elements or component parts and identify relationships among these parts. Other types of analysis assignments include applying theories or interpretive methods to the object of analysis or a particular school of thought, distinguishing facts from theories, evaluating the validity of stated or unstated assumptions and/or various types of relationships among events, identifying logical fallacies in arguments, or specifying the author's purpose, bias, or point of view. For example:
TLFeBOOK

1. *How does the bourgeoisie gradually undermine its own existence according to Marx?* (Philosophy) (Schoedinger, 2000, p. 215)
2. *How do the elasticities of supply and demand affect the deadweight loss of a tax ? Why do they have this effect ?* (Economics) (Mankiw, 2001, p. 176)
3. *If class, race, and gender are positions within social structures, we should be able to describe them in terms of power, prestige, privileges, role, identity, and perspective. Can you do this?* (Sociology) (Charon, 1999, p. 86)

Exemplification Tasks

Exemplification and illustration largely deals with expanding on theories/ concepts/ ideas and providing reasonable amounts of detail to explain a type, class, or group of objects or events by presenting examples. These assignments largely rely on general-to-specific discourse organization flow.

For example,
1. *Give at least two examples of what children can learn from playing peek-a-boo.* (Psychology) (Epstein, 1999, p. 258)
2. *What is a simple idea, according to Locke? Give examples.* (Philosophy)
(Adapted from Schoedinger, 2000, p. 351)

Discrepancies of Teaching Reading and Writing Skill in Pakistani Schools

Though it claims to handle oral skills, the exclusive use of mechanical pronunciation and dictation tasks cannot foster these skills [see section 4.9.2 above]. The grammar content is limited to basic definitions and simple exercises dealing with nouns, simple present tense, adjectives, adverbs, articles,

pronouns and sentence types. Importantly, the skills are practiced in isolation and there is no focus on integration.

The functional aspect of language is completely ignored. The pronunciation tasks focus on isolated words only. The new vocabulary is mainly introduced through the reading texts. Their Urdu meanings are provided at the back of the book. The vocabulary development activities are of two types – making sentences with the unfamiliar lexis and completing gapped passages/ sentences exactly reproduced from the text. The second task type is especially ineffective since the exact words can easily be copied from the provided texts, even if the learners do not understand their meaning or usage.

Characteristics of English curriculum in Pakistani government schools

Overall, the curriculum appears to cater to the future academic and professional needs of the learners. First of all, it focuses on all aspects of language – structure, phonology, lexis, discourse and the four skills. Moreover, it suggests the use of a variety of activities and texts and introduces the concept of purposeful reading and writing. It also deals with the functional aspect of oral interaction and aims to provide practice in oral activities which the students may be required to undertake beyond the classrooms, like interviews and presentations.

Why receptive and productive skills are integrated?

Most teachers would probabí>’ agree that one answer is that students should be able to understand

aud produce the language that they need —in other words, we want them to develop their autonomy in language use, that is, a kind of freedom in their choice of language and manner. By integrating skills we are providing a certain input that becomes a basis for further output, which in turn will be new input, and so on. In this way the students’ contribut¡ons turn out to be pafl of the process in which language is generated.

Writing skill is considered to be a nucleus of linguistic knowledge.

Writing is not a skill which can be leamed in isolation. In the apprentice stage of writing, what tIte student must learn, apart from the peculiar difficulties of spelling or script, is a counterpart of what has to be learnt for tIte mastery of listening comprehension, speaking and readiííg —a nucleus of linguistic knowledge. Thc aetivity of writing helps to consolidate the knowledge for use in other areas, since it gives the student practice in manipulating structures and selecting and combining lexical elements.

Written questions based on a reading passage eneourage the student to read Ihe text more attentively and discover areas which were misinterpreted on tIte first reading. Oní>’ by hearing and reading a great deal of thc language as it is spoken and written by native speakers can language learners acquire that feeling for the appropriate use of language forms and combinations, which is basic to expressive writing.